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BABY DINOSAUR FACTS

- 1 The skeletons of some tiny newborn dinosaurs could fit in a human's hand.
- 2 Baby duck-billed dinosaurs, like *Maiasaura*, doubled in size in just six weeks.
- 3 *Apatosaurus* babies had to gain 30 lb (14 kg) of weight a day to reach their adult size of 19.8 tons (18 metric tons).

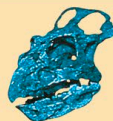
At 30 ft (9 m) long, the mother *Maiasaura* was the same length as a bus.

Maiasaura mother

Discoveries of the fossilized remains of adult *Maiasaura* next to hundreds of nests, eggs, and young show that the mothers took care of their babies. This is why this dinosaur was given the name *Maiasaura*, as it means "good mother lizard."

Growing up

The fossilized remains of large groups of *Protoceratops* have been found in deserts in Asia. The skulls show how their heads changed in shape and size as these dinosaurs grew up.



Hatchling skull

The skull of a baby *Protoceratops* shows the basic head shape, including the eye sockets and a tiny neck frill.



Juvenile skull

As *Protoceratops* starts to grow up, its beak gets longer, helping it to feed on plants.



Sub-adult skull

The cheeks have become wider and the beak more narrow. The neck frill is more developed.



Adult skull

The fully grown *Protoceratops* skull has a strong neck frill and large cheek horns. Adults were about the size of a sheep.

» Scale



Adult *Protoceratops*